



Prepare your design file for uploading to VistaPrint

Get your design print-ready with:

 **Canva Free**

 **Canva Pro**

 **Adobe Illustrator**

Set up your design file with Canva Free

1. Go to the **File** menu in the top-left corner, select **Settings** and choose **Show print bleed**.
A line will appear near the edges of your design, indicating the bleed area.

Download your design with crop marks and bleed

2. Go to the **Share** button in the top-right corner, select **Download** and choose **PDF Print** as the file type.
3. Check the box for **Crop marks and bleed**, then **Download** your print-ready file.

Upload and print with VistaPrint

4. On VistaPrint, upload the PDF file you downloaded from Canva.
5. Enlarge your artwork to extend the crop marks past the Bleed Area to avoid unwanted white edges or visible crop marks.
6. Select **Preview** to double check your design.

Set up your design file with Canva Pro

1. Go to **File** in the top left corner, select **Settings** and choose **Show margins**.
2. Place all important text and images inside the margin.

Choose the correct dimensions based on VistaPrint's product specifications

3. Go to **Resize** in the top left corner.
4. Apply **Custom Size** and set your business card dimensions to 3.62" (width) x 2.12" (height)
5. Select **Copy & resize** and **Open** the file in updated dimensions for VistaPrint.

Download your Canva design

6. Go to **File**, select **Download** and choose **PDF Print** from the File type menu.
7. Choose **CMYK** in the Color profile menu and **Download** (Canva exports in RGB by default, but VistaPrint prints in CMYK).

Review your PDF file

8. Open your PDF file to check all important elements are within the safety line and not too close to the edges.
9. Check for typos, incorrect colors and misplaced design elements.

Upload your file to VistaPrint

10. Go to the VistaPrint website and select the product and size/orientation.
11. Choose **Upload design** and select the PDF file you downloaded from Canva.
12. Preview your file to make sure it aligns correctly with VistaPrint's template before moving forward.

Check for print warnings

If VistaPrint flags any issues (like low image resolution), adjust your design in Canva, export it again and make any necessary adjustments to align with the print margins.

VistaPrint uses the following language to guide you:

Bleed line marks the outermost point where your product can be cut.

Safety line shows where you have to keep text, photos and images inside.

Trim area is the space between the safety line and the bleed line where your product is cut.

Helpful design tips

- VistaPrint prints in CMYK, but Canva exports in RGB, so colors may appear slightly different in print
- Keep text at 10 point or larger to ensure readability
- For rich blacks, use C40, M30, Y30, K100 in your design
- Avoid using transparency effects (Multiply, Overlay) as they may not print correctly
- While PDF is preferred, you can also upload JPEG or PNG (at 300 dpi)

Set up your design file with Adobe Illustrator

Getting started

1. Download the blank PDF from VistaPrint, import it into Adobe Illustrator and select page 1 (front side of template).
2. Go to the **Layers** panel, add a new layer below Layer 1 and name it “My design”.
3. Lock Layer 1 to keep it in place.
4. Create your final design in the new “My design” layer.

Embed your images

5. Go to **Window**, select **Links** and choose **Embed Images**.

Outline your text

6. Save a backup of your PDF.
7. Select all editable text, then go to **Type** and select **Create Outlines**.
8. Extend the bleed to the outer blue line of the art board.

Convert your colors to CMYK

9. Go to **File**, select **Document Color Mode** and choose **CMYK Color**.

Save your PDF

10. Hide or delete all layers except the “My design” layer.
11. Go to **File**, select **Save As**, choose **Adobe PDF** and **Save**.
12. From the **Adobe PDF Preset** dropdown menu, select **High Quality Print** then **Save PDF**.

Reduce file size if it's over 30 MB

13. Go to **File**, select **Save As**, choose **General**, uncheck **Preserve Illustrator Editing Capabilities** then **Save PDF**.

More design tips

- Do not rotate or change the size of the original template
- For multiply, overlay or gradient effects, rasterize your final PDF in Photoshop, then flatten the layer by selecting **Save As** and choosing **Photoshop PDF** or **JPEG**
- Keep text at 10 point or larger for optimal readability (about 1/8” tall)
- For rich blacks, use C40, M30, Y30, K100 in your design
- Save file as .pdf (recommended), .psd, .jpg, .png or .ai at 300dpi
- Remove overprint settings by selecting **Window**, choosing **Attributes** and unchecking **Overprint Fill** and **Overprint Stroke**
- Check image sharpness by zooming in 100–200%